

pricing reflects the cost structure of the vehicle. Second, we have diversified our portfolio recognising that consumers are price sensitive. The same customers use different products at different times. That is a superpower which we have as a platform, where customers are able to stay on the platform because we are able to offer them multiple use cases.

Third, our core technology is driving utilisation in a very material way. Because we build technologies for our global operations—which works in 60+ countries—we are able to find optimisations much faster. We also focus on the discipline of this cost structure. We have less than 250 people running the entire India business (except the global tech team), and that helps us keep the pricing low for the passengers.

Q: Could you outline the safety enhancements and measures that have been implemented?

A: We put safety front and centre in everything we do. For several years now, there has been a high bar on background checks, not just for car drivers, but also auto drivers. We have put in place a technology infrastructure that gives support like sharing trip details, ride check that tracks unexpected long stops, and 24x7 safety helpline, for the passengers and drivers during the trip and even after the trip.

In certain cities, law enforcement agencies have made their infra available; we have integrated our safety helpline with that. We anonymise all calls. We also provide comprehensive accident insurance for drivers and riders. We have taken more than 100,000 drivers through in-person gender sensitisation training. Also introduced driver selfies to ensure the person driving the car is the same person who is registered. We are piloting multiple experiments globally such as audio recording with the permission of passengers and drivers; we will see if that product makes sense in India. We are also working on specific safety features for women drivers.

Q: How are you approaching profitability?

A: We have built an incredibly strong top line and scale, and are growing fast from there. On the bottom line, we have made some tremendous progress on profitability, which is allowing Dara and the global leadership to lean in even further on the India market. We run a very disciplined business. We have proven that we can actually run a very strong, economically viable business in a low-fare market like India, where there are multiple competitors. And we operate in a commercially-licenced market, which means there is a cost of supply that is higher than other markets.

I wouldn't be able to give specifics [on revenue and profitability], but large parts of our portfolio are in a

“Our tech centre in Bengaluru is one of the largest globally, outside the US... His (CEO Khosrowshahi's) view is that in the spirit of being disruptive, sometimes we antagonise local stakeholders like unions. He encourages local teams to find common ground with policymakers”

very good place in terms of continuously improving economics. And we feel good about making long-term investments on the back of that.

There is still more to do in India, because the total penetration of ride sharing is still very low here. That is why we need more product lines like buses, autos, cars and EVs that can meet the requirement of consumers.

[The] India business is not about milestones. We are here for multiple decades to come. For now, we are just putting our heads down and focussing on innovation and execution. There is so much more to be done.

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Q: What are the specific steps Uber India is taking to implement the electrification strategy?

A: Globally, we have committed to become emission free across our platform by 2040. India fits into that plan. However, the pace at which electrification will happen will be a function of how ready the ecosystem is, where multiple models have to be available, cost has to be reasonable, and the charging infra has to be readily available. We anticipate that India is seeing early momentum even though the tipping point is yet to come.

We are leaning in as a leading player to commit to launching Uber Green in three markets. We believe sustainability is a team game where everyone needs to play their part. Therefore, we are working with multiple players in the ecosystem to ensure access to vehicles, enable charging infrastructure, and unlock financing. We see our role as a catalyst in the full value chain.

Right now we have more than 6,000 EVs on the platform across vehicle segments. We have made an internal commitment that we want to have at least 25,000 electric cars on our platform by 2025, which will be a sizeable part of the cars fleet. **BT**

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